



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National police college of Jamaica Communication Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

Title: JCF NPCJ Communication Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Number: JCF/NPCJ-TB/PL/SFs/0004/2025
Effective Date: 2025-Mar-19	Pages: 8
Review Date: nil	Distribution: NPCJ
Revision #: 0	Process Owners: ACP NPCJ
Rescinds: nil	
Authors: NPCJ	Process Owner: JCF
First Published: 2025-Mar-19	Review: Triennially

Table of Contents

1.0 Introduction.....	3
2.0 Purpose.....	3
3.0 Scope.....	3
4.0 Policy statements	3
5.0 Abbreviations & Acronyms.....	3
6.0 Definitions.....	3
7.0 Responsibilities	4
8.0 Standard Operating Procedures.....	5
8.7 Training and Awareness	8
9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles	8
10.0 Relevant Records and Forms	8

1.0 Introduction

The National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) is dedicated to fostering a professional and efficient communication structure that supports its mandate of training law enforcement personnel. This Communication Policy and Standard Operating Procedures establish clear guidelines for internal and external communication, crisis response, media engagement, and digital communication. This ensures alignment with the communication policies and procedures of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) and the Government of Jamaica (GOJ).

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- 2.1. Ensure accurate, timely, and secure dissemination of information.
- 2.2 Define roles and responsibilities in communication.
- 2.3 Establish procedures for handling confidential information.
- 2.4 Provide a structured approach to managing internal and external communications, crisis communications, and digital engagement.

3.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedure applies to all sworn and unsworn personnel at the National Police College of Jamaica. It covers staff, recruits, and students and governs communication across all NPCJ training programs, divisions, and facilities

4.0 Policy statements

It is the policy of the National Police College of Jamaica to:

- 4.1 ensure accurate, timely, and secure dissemination of information within NPCJ;
- 4.2 maintain transparency and accessibility in communication while adhering to confidentiality requirements;
- 4.3 establish clear protocols for handling crises and emergencies;
- 4.4 enhance public confidence in NPCJ through responsible media and public engagement; and
- 4.5 ensure communication processes align with national security protocols and police training standards.

5.0 Abbreviations & Acronyms

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
CCN	Constabulary Communication Network
GOJ	Government of Jamaica
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
NPCJ	National Police College of Jamaica

6.0 Definitions

- 6.1 Communication:** The exchange of information through verbal, written, electronic, or visual means between individuals, groups, or organizations. In the context of NPCJ, communication includes written and verbal official announcements, operational

directives, internal memos, training materials, media statements, and emergency notifications.

6.2 Confidential Communication: Any communication containing sensitive or restricted information protected from unauthorized access, including personnel records, operational plans, legal documents, and intelligence reports.

6.3 Crisis Communication: The strategies and processes used to communicate effectively during emergencies, including security incidents, natural disasters, and institutional crises.

6.4 Data: Any recorded information, whether in electronic, written, or physical form, that is used for operational, training, academic, or administrative purposes at NPCJ. Data may include personal records, educational information, security reports, digital communications, and operational intelligence. Data must be managed in compliance with the Data Protection Act (2020) and NPCJ's information security protocols.

6.5 Digital Communication: Electronic means to share information, including emails, websites, intranet systems, and social media platforms.

6.6 External Communication: Any communication between NPCJ and the wider JCF external stakeholders, including government agencies, the media, the public, and international partners.

6.7 Internal Communication: Communication occurring within NPCJ, including directives, bulletins, memoranda, notices, posting, emails, intranet messages, and official meetings.

6.8 Stakeholders: Individuals, groups, or entities interested in NPCJ's activities, including law enforcement agencies, government ministries, academic institutions, trainees, and the public.

7.0 Responsibilities

7.1 Assistant Commissioner of Police Training Branch will:

- 7.1.1 oversee, and enforce NPCJ's communication policies in alignment with JCF and GOJ standards;
- 7.1.2 ensure all official communications reflect the mission, vision and values of NPCJ;
- 7.1.3 coordinate crisis communication strategies and emergency notifications;
- 7.1.4 review and approve Press releases and official statements before publication;
- 7.1.5 monitor and address internal and external inquiries; and
- 7.1.6 monitor compliance with all relevant Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) policies and procedures.

7.2 Communications Liaison Officer will:

- 7.2.1 act as the main liaison for media and public relations to the Constabulary Communication Network (CCN) on behalf of NPCJ;
- 7.2.2 develop and disseminate press releases, public statements, and internal announcements;
- 7.2.3 manage NPCJ's digital platforms, including official social media, intranet, and website content; and
- 7.2.4 manage NPCJ's official social media accounts and digital communications.

7.3 Heads of Departments will:

- 7.3.1 ensure departmental communication aligns with NPCJ's policies and JCF protocols;
- 7.3.2 disseminate critical training and operational information to staff, and students; and
- 7.3.3 provide updates and briefings during emergencies, training changes, or administrative decisions.

7.4 Staff and Students will:

- 7.4.1 adhere to communication guidelines, particularly in handling confidential or sensitive information;
- 7.4.2 report any misinformation, unauthorized disclosures, or security concerns regarding NPCJ communication; and
- 7.4.3 use official NPCJ-approved channels for disseminating internal and external communications.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

8.1 Internal Communication Protocols

- 8.1.1 Official NPCJ announcements must be conveyed through authorized channels, including official emails, the NPCJ intranet, internal bulletins, and scheduled briefings.
- 8.1.2 Training schedules, administrative notices, and all critical NPCJ operational information must be disseminated to all staff within 24-48 hours after approval.
- 8.1.3 Confidential documents and correspondence must be restricted to authorized personnel.
- 8.1.4 NPCJ will utilize secure messaging (WhatsApp), Email (JCF Webmail) System or other method of communication approved by the JCF for sensitive internal communication.

8.2 External Communication Protocols

8.2.1 Communication with Stakeholders

- 8.2.1.1 Correspondence with government entities must follow GOJ's official communication protocols.
- 8.2.1.2 Quarterly briefings will be conducted to provide updates on training programs and institutional developments.
- 8.2.1.3 ACP Training/Director of NPCJ will review and approve formal agreements or Memoranda of Understanding (MOU) before dissemination.

8.2.2 Media and Public Relations

- 8.2.2.1 All media interactions must be coordinated through the Communications Liaison Officer.
- 8.2.2.2 Unauthorized statements on behalf of NPCJ are strictly prohibited.
- 8.2.2.3 Interviews with media representatives must be pre-approved and comply with JCF's Media Relations Policy.

8.2.3 Digital and Social Media Communication

- 8.2.3.1 All online content must adhere to the JCF's social media and media relations policies
- 8.2.3.2 The unauthorized dissemination of NPCJ-related content, particularly regarding law enforcement training and operations, is prohibited.

N.B: Therefore, no confidential, operational, or training-sensitive information such as postings, pictures of the barrack room, classrooms, dining area, kitchen, bathrooms, or any other sensitive area as determined by ACP Training or his designate shall be posted on social media or public forums.

8.3 Crisis Communication Plan

8.3.1 Emergency Communication

- 8.3.1.1 In an emergency (e.g., security threats, natural disasters, health crises), NPCJ will activate its Operational Continuity Policy.
- 8.3.1.2 The Communications Officer will issue alerts through emergency notifications to staff and students, announcements via NPCJ's website, intranet, email systems.
- 8.3.1.3 Coordination with government agencies for broader emergency communication.

8.3.2 Incident Reporting

- 8.3.2.1 All security or emergency incidents must be reported to NPCJ administration and relevant authorities immediately.
- 8.3.2.2 A designated crisis communication team will manage media inquiries and official statements.
- 8.3.2.3 Information updates will be provided regularly to prevent misinformation and speculation.

8.4 Documentation, confidential communication, and record management

8.4.1 Confidential Communication

- 8.4.1.1 All confidential communication within NPCJ must comply with the Official Secrets Act and Data Protection Act (2020).
- 8.4.1.2 Sensitive information related to law enforcement training, operational procedures, or personnel records must only be shared on a need-to-know basis and through secure communication channels—webmail or approved email and WhatsApp Groups.
- 8.4.1.3 NPCJ personnel must use encrypted communication when handling classified or sensitive information.
- 8.4.1.4 Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information is strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action and legal consequences.
- 8.4.1.5 Internal communication involving student records, personnel data, and training assessments must comply with data protection regulations to prevent unauthorized access or leaks.
- 8.4.1.6 Meetings discussing confidential matters must be held in secure locations, and minutes must be classified accordingly.

8.5 Data Protection and Compliance

- 8.5.1 NPCJ will ensure compliance with the Data Protection Act (2020) to safeguard personal and institutional data.
- 8.5.2 All personal information collected, stored, and processed by NPCJ
- 8.5.3 must be secured in accordance with the following data protection principles outlined in the Act:
 - i. Lawfulness, fairness, and transparency
 - ii. Purpose limitation
 - iii. Data minimization
 - iv. Accuracy
 - v. Storage limitation
 - vi. Integrity and confidentiality (security)
 - vii. Accountability
 - viii. Data subject rights
- 8.5.4 Access to personal and confidential data will only be limited to authorized personnel.
- 8.5.5 NPCJ will implement security measures, including firewalls, encryption, and access controls, to protect sensitive digital and physical records.
- 8.5.6 Data breaches must be reported to the Information Communication and Technology Division (ICTD) as required.
- 8.5.7 Staff handling personal data will receive mandatory training on compliance with data protection laws and best practices.

8.6 Documentation and Record Management

- 8.6.1 All official NPCJ communication, including emails, memos, and reports, must be archived in compliance with the GOJ Records Management Act.
- 8.6.2 Confidential information must be managed according to NPCJ's Information Security Policy.
- 8.6.3 A document retention policy will ensure proper handling and disposal of outdated communication records.

8.7 Training and Awareness

- 8.7.1 NPCJ will conduct periodic training on communication protocols and professional correspondence for staff and students.
- 8.7.2 Crisis communication drills and emergency response simulations will be conducted annually with JCF and ODPEM.
- 8.7.3 Digital security and social media best practices training will be integrated into NPCJ staff development programs.

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

This Policy shall be read in conjunction with the following legislation and guiding principles

- 9.1 Data Protection Act
- 9.2 Official Secrets Act
- 9.3 JCF Corporate Use of Social Media Policy
- 9.4 JCF Media Relations Policy
- 9.5 NPCJ's Operational Continuity Policy

9.0 Relevant Records and Forms

- 10.1 JCF Webmail
- 10.2 NPCJ Shared Drive